O’ muse of beauty, pearl of my eye, angel of creation.
O’ mother! From where does your brilliance come?
Tell me, so that I might visit that far off cave by the sea and leave offerings of ripened fruit at the foot of the Goddess who lives inside (of me, of you) and listen to the waves breathe softly against the shore.

And all the things I could do to you
And all the things you could do to me
And all the things I could do to you
And all the things you could do to me

What a song we should sing together

H A P P I N E S S

Is a

Goddess

And just like all devī
She requires
Devotion.
What will you give her
In return for her presence.

Are you truly
devoted to that which you call upon?

BLUE

Look at her. Isn’t she just the most perfect shade of blue you’ve ever seen? You think you know blue all your life and then……boom. One day, you realize——You've never really. You gotta stop to appreciate the sky sometimes, you know? You see how it fades out into the distance and gets deeper right above you?

Atomic peace
Made of heaven’s most holy observations,
Of beauty
Drawn pure from a cosmic spring,
In the middle of the distant darkness
And poured out over the spirit,
Over and over and over and over,
In effortless fruition,
Rippling on the surface of the tide’s embrace.

You are the flirtation in
the word *caipirinha*.
The sighs living in the
pronunciation
Of *susurro,*
    reach out to caress
your
Skin scrubbed soft with
sugar and olive oil

Língua da serpente, feitiço
do gato

Te adoro mais y mais.

BOSSA NOVA

LULUMAHU

I climbed
The luscious body
Of a heaven

That bares a name I cannot pronounce,
And responds to songs I do not know.
And at the foot of her holy fountain
I went to cry, to show my overflowing joy,
And gratitude
For having been allowed to be present,
And yet no tears would come.

The mountain told me,
She did not need my tears,
To see the happiness I brought her,
As my one and only offering.

Let the water weep for you,
Let the rain cry for you,
Let the river be the flowing of your tears.
Eternal happiness is yours,
And you needn't cry anymore,
Even to show the universe
How happy you are to see
All the glory she has created.

There must be moonlight in your eyes.

How else would I feel every ocean, river, and lake inside of me

Weaken

When ever you look at me?

THE RIVER

And the river loved me so,
That she vowed neither she nor I would rest,
Until I was back within her tender embrace.

Why did you let me go?
You did not have to, and yet,
You did.
How could you love me and discard
me?

I do not have an answer,
Said the river.
Or perhaps I underestimate
The love I have to give.

Sharing fruit is a sacred love language,

Reserved for those,
Who earn the trust of Tenderness.

What will you do
Now that you've seen the clementines
and peaches of me?

I have eaten far too many

Cantaloupe and savored much too many

Plums, in this short, sweet life of mine

Not to be overflowing with nectar and juices.

A drowning sacral point

Asks for release.

Reach down into my brass kalasha,

And recover a hand with fingers

Painted yellow like the pollen of lilies.

LAKSHMI

NIGHTINGALE

Mother Mary, my canary wont fly

Since she left me
Drowning
In the
Window
Of her mind

If I could escape
I would
Without a trace of me
Left in the night

But I'm caught up in the reason and the
Rhythm of her sheets
Three hours behind
And losing time to forgetful days
As they pass by

And *if I just learn*
to keep you satisfied
you'd never stray

Would you imagine
The surprise on my face

When I had come to understand
Youd never be mine

My body feels
too heavy to carry
alone.

I need a love and lover
To collapse into.
Not through like a penny and a cloud,
But a face pressing into a belly,
Sinking gently.

Deep enough to feel your pulse beneath me,
Soft enough to forget I'm not dreaming,
Warm enough to convince me,
One more time,
Ive found something to float on.

The scent of jasmine

Lifts me from my sleeping

Mind and into a state of
Being more blessed than
The exact line of the horizon

Where the azure of the ocean
Bleeds into the cyan of the sky

Gently allowing herself to fade
into nothingness and completeness

Perfectly and without fail.

I no longer see a use for comparison.
For I've accepted it serves me no good.
And have learned to see
myself,
Without having to first see another.

I shall call this magic .

KINDNESS

When I look at you,
I see that you try very hard
And push against the sand of each moment,
Striving to grasp a meaning
That will make the mess make sense.

So I will try to decide
To treat you with warmth.
As another tiny creature in the big colorful void
Trying to reach its finger out,
Carve a line, and leave a mark
In the wet clay of memory as you pass by.

How beautiful it is
To have your entire body, spirit, and being
Braced to experience
The sourness life often has to offer,
But instead receive
An unexpected kindness
To hopefully notice, hold on to for the next few steps, and keep
moving to your destination.

SWEET SPOT

(I'm happy you find me deserving of so much caution, but in truth, you've always been overly fretful. I'd really prefer if…)

At the crossroads
Of simplicity and giving me the world,
You meet me in the middle
Of a sweet spot made of
Vulnerability and trust.

From here,
We could go anywhere,
Do anything,
On a wish and a risk.
Making a way
Out of our shared yes's and will do's.
An adventure we create together,
Remaining deserving of one another,
As we grow into different versions of ourselves.

A liberating, activating type of tenderness.
Like a passing rain you never saw
Still damp in the grass,
Suddenly and honestly cool on your bare naked feet,
As you step into the real world for the first time.

JOY IN THE CUT

O!

There is joy in the cut,
Magic in the flesh,
Happiness in the wound
That the brave heart makes to unfetter itself from worry.

Sweet Liberty, be my lover.

I want to glide across the night-time of my fears, Alight with your divine ecstasy.
On top of me, a movin and shakin of the Spirit, and the sweat of my warm body making a rain
of June.

High…and higher…and higher…and so high…

INHERITANCE

"... And then, altogether unexpected,
One day, a voice fell on me
Like cool , cool water

And told me that if I should

Just
let all the pain and sorrow go
Away like rain drops
forgotten in a river
The sweetest death
I've ever know
Would wash over my spirit,
Give me all I've ever imagined,
And then the unimaginable."

"The magic preceded me, you see.
I do not know when the prayer that changed
My life started. But I know that even with
A tongue of amber and glass,

I do not possess the power alone
To perform the miracles I have experienced."

You are not simply a sum of your scars.

You are absolutely and completely
Delightful, joyous, and beautiful.

Whatever wounds you have received
Are undeserved, and not a reflection
Of the gentle spirit you now
Cradle fretfully inside of you,
Like a mouth shut right around a tongue,
Protecting its ever-anxious
Muscle of expression.

And I hope you know
That even with your bruises and boundaries
You are wonderful to simply behold.
It is an honor and privilege and pleasure
To know you,
Exactly as you show up.

Go weep
Not from joy,
Nor sadness,
Pain nor triumph,
But from an ecstasy of the spirit
Overwhelmed
Overstimulated.
The tinkling and tantalizing
Of the bells that embroider the trellises
Of your soul’s sacred garment.

Vibrate, shake, tremble, and quake

There is a catharsis you yearn for,
To shiver and orgasm away old skins
That no longer belong to you.
O’ what necessary-saccharine-sweet n’ holy release.

SWEET NOTHING

I had a vision one day
I saw a vision of you in my
right eye
Looking like a picture of
expression
Moving like melody to the music
of my mind

And it was sweet like
sweet light

Sweet like honeydew
Sweet like mangoes
Sweet where the rain goes
Sweet like strawberries
glistening in the sun

Yeah baby you sweet like (sweet
light)
Sweet like I wanna fuck you
through the
moonlight
Just to see the sparkle in your
eyes
Just to see the sun in the
morning
On your beautiful face

Sweet like put a charm on you if
wanted to
Just to see the music float
through you

Sexiest thing I've ever
seen
It’s all in you darling

the beach in the back my mind
remembers the scent of you
like warm rain in the sand
caramel hibiscus burnt
marshmallow sea salt
driftwood
dayworn and mellifluent
hair and cotton rubbed
skin
on a blanket we lay in the
dark and the calm before the
storm

TASTE

Devour me
Crave me
Lap me up
Hunger for me
Insatiably want me
Let me linger on the back of your tongue
Open your mouth to drip for me
Desire the taste of me
Because I am too delicious
And nourishing and sweet
To be simply nibbled upon.

There is a *God* in your head who has given you everything you have. The Mirror is holy for its ability to show you this Deity.

Divine alignment is only ever a glance away.

Every inch of her is perfect.

I needed a reflection to show me,
How perfectly I am made.
What a shame.
But how else would I have known.
I am merely human,
And most often only believe what I see.

The people who grew used
To your kindness as a treat
Will suddenly turn into dogs
When suddenly you deny them
The sweet they took for granted.

TRANSFIGURATION

All of the lakes
that once pooled inside of me,
with water reserved for my tears,
have dried and left valleys of wild flowers
in their wake.

I'll let the waterfall possess me,

Fill my bathtub up all the way,

Just to show myself I can,

Channel such an overflow.

A surge of inspiration,

All over me and throughout me,

Like the full force of Spring.

Full of water, full of life

Full of water, full of life

Miraculous and joyful,

Jubilant she was born.

Way down in her belly

Is from where the rainfall came.

I adore you like rain

adores a window,

Come let me curiously caress
tenderly, and your face.

I stained my mouth with cherries,
And my whole body blushed burgundy.
By the way the juices
Sat on my lips
I knew I was a girl.

Nobody gave me this fruit.

I made this divinity of Mine
Out of sacred sticks and herbs.
Duck feathers and stones
The color of frankincense resin,
Collected from the banks of ponds who listened to me cry and taught me gratitude.

Walked trails through unknown forests,
To find brooks that giggled
And cooed like newborn babies,
Through the black mud and moss of midsummer.
Caught leopard-painted caterpillars.
Watched them chrysalis over and hatch silently in shoeboxes,
Just to capture their powers of transformation.

I learned by listening to the breeze,
That the laughter of the birds
Is a song of fifty-five bells,
For whenever you are down,
To call upon the goddess of happiness
That lives inside.

WILDLING

LADEKOJU

I cannot see myself in the mirror.
So when you tell me I am beautiful,
Tell me the truth,
Because I trust you.

I cannot see myself in the mirror.
So make sure you mean it,
When you tell me I am beautiful.

I cannot trust my eyes,
Because I cannot see myself.

I am a fountain
It is my nature
To be overflowing

EBORI-ELEDA

A spirit like the blushing of a white peach
Brushes across my body
A burn
A scald
A mark
A scar that brands me as the
Preferred fruit of her sacrifice.

Forever may I be dressed in
Honey and perfumed powders.
Having been so chosen
For the holy chalk and flowers,
The meat of the prized lamb,
That tastes the flesh of the coconut
To purify its insides
Only to be eaten and consumed.

Do not lose your head for the cost of temptation, pretty one.

Darling,

Don't you ever change yourself for my love, Because I adore you for all that you already are. And I would hate to awake one morning, and come to find it crossed your brilliant mind, I don’t love you just as much as the first time I ever laid eyes on you.

I am enslaved to the very thought of you, my dear.

Sweetest, most tender utterance of perfection and beauty.
Most favorite daughter of God everlasting.
Blessed and uplifted highest in prayer among women.
All-knowing, all-loving,
Manifestation of mercy,
Crossing the sky above me in a procession of holy clouds.

The moon told me I was beautiful tonight
Grabbed my face
And looked at me
With big brown eyes
Oh those eyes. . .

Told me I was beautiful
In a voice that told me to hear her
Because she meant it
Not because I wanted to hear it
But because it was a truth
That needed to be heard
And received

She doesn't like to repeat herself,
And she told me I was beautiful *3* times.

OSUPA

ODI MEYI

Jet black soil
Wet, rich, fertile, and filthy
Beneath the grasses and weeds
Cold and damp underneath your feet.

The flowers exhale deep moans of fragrance
Into the mouths of birds and bees
Exchanging ancient kisses
While the trees secrete and sugar.
Rivers overflow.
Fruits mature, ripen, drop, and rot.

Nature is an act of seduction.
Fucking is primal.
Sex is instinctual play.
To lick and suck and taste,
Is a birthright of the body.
Your nose searches for a scent which warms your ears, belly, and pelvis,
Widens your hips and reminds you
That being touched,
When, and why, and how you want it,
Is one of the most powerful things you will ever experience.

Pleasure is an old god.
Who whispers to you,

“Don’t you know you must
Open a hole in the earth to plant a seed?
That all things buried in good faith and fertile soil
And given the space to delightfully fester in the mess that is creation,
Will always be reborn into something much greater than they were before.”

OSE MEYI

My mother gave birth to me
For the first time
Making me out of her own body
In the image of someone who would best
Receive the love and care She had to offer

Endlessly, fearlessly, freely, and without condition.

I then birthed myself
For the second time
Making me out of my own body
In the image of someone who would best
Receive the love and care I have to offer

Endlessly, fearlessly, freely, and without condition.

Unfortunately
The road of love is
And has always been
Bumpy and uneven
With heartbreak and loss
But be comforted by the truth
That is how it was designed.

AMARRO DE AMOR

You say you don’t love me.
But what if

I write your name twenty-five times
Down my spine
Rolled in honey and red sandalwood
Burned like a beeswax candle
On a plate of molasses and brown sugar
For five nights and seven days
Under the delicate and capricious
Shade of a bouquet of red carnations
In a dark room
Where amber colored spirits smoke incense
Like cigars and laugh in burned voices.
Dark liquor on their breath like perfume.

After the velvet shadow of my left hand
Passes like an incessant thought
Over our names written in cursive with
Red wine on parchment paper—

Would you love me then?

When you kiss me, Tell me you adore me By the way you exhale into my mouth.
When you look at me, Tell me you trust me, By the unwavering, fearless gaze you put into my eyes.
When you touch me, Tell me that you don't want to lose me Because the warmth between us reminds you of the sun.
Invite me into the place
Where the first stirrings Of your love and affection Come up from the earth and slowly pool Around your trembling ankles.
I want to love you in complete quiet and silence And still know that you choose me as I choose you.

VANITY IS A HARD EARNED GIFT
(I Give to Myself)

My vanity has nothing to do with you. It is the gift I give to myself in return for the years I spent only giving myself hate.
It is a daily miracle that I wake up with life in my eyes for myself. I do not think of you in that encounter.
Because in the process and journey of learning to love myself without measure, I have no space for you in my vessel.

I wanna love on you
Like ocean water collecting sacrificial offerings
From for the shore
Deposited by prayerful hands
In hopes of receiving some abundance in return.
My affection like a hand woven basket
Covered in cloth
Pregnant with the promises of a lover and a hungry mouth.

I wanna call you beautiful
In a way no one ever has.

That you might remember the way I looked at you tonight,
Twenty years from now,
When you forget how we met
But still carry the experience of being adored
Properly, wholly, and divinely
Is the sole objective.

Because you have known the scorn of love
And so have I
So why should we not be sweet to one another.

For one reason or another
Some of us learned to hold back tears
At a very young age.

And so have spent years,
Countless lost moments,
Not crying for things that ought be cried over.

No one told you that your tears are holy
And have the power to heal you,
That you are beautiful even when you break.

Water your garden
Sweetwater and rain fill the lakes of your head
For love, joy, fury and sadness you have tears.

OMI TUTU
ỌNA TUTU
TUTU ỌKAN

MY MOTHER’S LAUGH

Sounds like home.
Reminds me of the wealth I come from.
Brightens the day of all who hear it.
Is made of brass and silver.
Is sweet potato pie and mandarin.
Boils like water in a rose teapot.
Could wake up the dead.
Reaches me no matter where I am.
Asks me, “What’s the matter?”
Tells me, “You were born for greatness.”
Taught me to overcome misery.

Is the first love song I ever knew.
Is my oldest memory.
Knows me, uplifts me, blesses me.

Is the truest expression of joy that God has ever shown me.

MI COMPAÑERA

I have known Love.

She has shown me the tricklings of her
That disappear into
The middle of unnamed and forgotten forests
Only for the finding of the
Wandering, yet hopeful mind.

I know Love well.
Yes, she has been with me forever.
Held my hand when I was young
And taught me how to find her inside myself
So that Id always know what she felt like
When I tried to find her affection in another.

When I tell you I have known Love,
I am saying to you that I have
Followed her up mountains and carried her in my arms when she was in pain.
She has given me so much
And I, to her.

For I have known Love.
I know her well.
She is my friend.

And all the things I could do to you
And all the things you could do to me
And all the things I could do to you
And all the things you could do to me

What a song we should sing together